Fully Committed

By Becky Mode

Phones are ringing. Sam rushes in, put on his/her headset with a crazy frantic energy and . . .

SAM: **(Pg 11)** Good morning reservations; could you hold please? *(multiple lines continue to ring throughout this exchange)*

MRS. VANDEVERE: Is the chef there?

SAM: No, he's not. Could you hold please?

MRS. VANDEVERE: Is Jean-Claude there?

SAM: No, he's not, could you hold please?

MRS. VANDEVERE: Is Bob there?

SAM: No, he's not. Could you hold on for one second?

MRS. VANDEVERE: Ye-es

SAM: Good morning, reservations, could you hold please?

INTRODUCTION

Meet Sam, a struggling actor/actress waiting for his/her big break. In the meantime, he/she make ends meet by taking reservations at the most in-demand high-end restaurant in Manhattan. Fortunately many of the skills Sam uses at the restaurant can readily be applied to his/her future stage career: How to deal with difficult people . . . . Staying calm, no matter what . . . and the beautiful art of improvisation!

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SAM: **(Pg 13-14)** *(buzzes upstairs)* Hey, Stephanie. Have you seen Bob? *(Phone rings)*

STEPHANIE: No, but when he comes in will you tell him that there's a photographer from Gourmet magazine who's been waiting for the chef since eight-thirty. *(Phone is still ringing)*

SAM: Okay. *(On to a new line)* Reservations, could you hold please?

MRS. VANDEVER: No, I tried that before. Who am I speaking with?

SAM: This is Sam.

MRS. VANDEVERE: *(Suddenly kissing up)* Sam, darling, I didn't know you were still work there. It's Bunny Vandevere *(a beat)* My husband is Dick Vandevere.

SAM: Oh, hi, how are you?

MRS. VANDEVERE: Well we're exhausted; we've just come back from Tibet. Now, I know it's last minute, but Mr. Vandevere and I want to come in tonight and we can be very flexible – anywhere between, say, seven-thirty and eight o'clock

SAM: Okay, one moment please. *(Putting her on hold and buzzing upstairs)* Hello. Jean-Claude? Oscar!! Oscar –

OSCAR: Sam, greeting and salutations. How are you?

SAM: Good, Oscar . . . hey, how VIP is Mrs. Vandevere?

OSCAR: V.V.V.V.I.P

SAM: She wants to come in tonight and I'm over by twenty-five.

OSCAR: Sam, her husband invented Saran Wrap!

SAM: *(Back to Vandevere)* Okay, Mrs. Vandevere. I just spoke to our business manager and you're all set for tonight. How about seven-thirty? *(Phone rings)*

MRS. VANDEVERE: That's marvelous, thank you so much Sam.

SAM: **(Pg 17)** *(On to a new line)* Thank you for holding, how can I help you?

ROSENSTEIN-FISHBURN (R-F): *(Like a drill sergeant)* First of all, I've been holding for ten minutes! Number two, you have to do something about that music. I need to speak to Jean-Claude regarding Friday evening. It's Carolann Rosenstein-Fishburn.

SAM: He's not in yet, can I – *(Dial tone, she's hung up)* Hello? *(Phone rings, Sam moves on to the new line)* Good morning, reservations, could you hold please?

STEPHANIE: **(Pg 19)** *(buzzing in)* Sam! It's the chef on line two.

SAM: *(On to line two)* Chef?

CHEF: *(Still half asleep)* What did we do last night?

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SAM: *(Checking a list)* It looks like $22,700.

CHEF: What does lunch look like?

SAM: We're all booked up.

CHEF: *(Snarling)* What did you just say? Did you forget my new policy?

SAM: No, we're "fully committed"

CHEF: That more like it. *(He hangs up, the phone rings)*

SAM: **(Pg 21-22)** Reservations, could you hold please?

R-F: It's Carolann Rosenstein-Fishburn calling for Jean-Claude. Did you forget to give him the message.

SAM: One moment please *(Buzzing upstairs)* Jean-Claude!

JEAN-CLAUDE: Allo, be brief. What can I do for you? *(and then snippy)* I'm trying to get ready for lunch up here!

SAM: Carolann Rosenstein-Fishburn on line four.

JEAN-CLAUDE: *(Disgusted)* Oh my God, I hate that lady. She's has a face like a dog.

SAM: *(Back to R-F)* Okay, Mrs. Fishburn, I can't find Jean-Claude, but I'll have him call you as soon as he gets in.

R-F: Tell [him] it's an urgent situation.

SAM: Are you sure there's nothing I . . . *(Dial tone; she's hung up.) (On to the next line)* **(Pg 15-16)** Thank you for holding, how can I help you?

BRYCE: *(Frighteningly cheerful)* Hi, this is Bryce calling from Naomi Campbell's office!! Who's this?

SAM: Sam.

BRYCE: *(Pathologically excited to talk to Sam)* Sam!!! I didn't know you were still working there! How's the acting career?

SAM: It's okay.

BRYCE: *(Gushing sympathy)* Oh, it's such a tough business! Hang in there! *(quickly shifting gears)* Okay, Naomi would like to come in this weekend with fifteen people, on

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Saturday night at eight PM and she's gonna need a round, fee-standing table . . . number seventeen.

SAM: Of course.

BRYCE: And you know she doesn't eat dairy, right? And no female waitstaff at the table!

SAM: Okay.

BRYCE: **(Pg 22)** Okay, so she definitely needs an all-vegan tasting menu. That's a no-fat, no-salt, no-dairy, no-sugar, no-chicken, no-meat, no-fish tasting menu for fifteen okay?

SAM: Okay, I'll make a note of that.

BRYCE: Super, thanks a trillion!

SAM: **(Pg 26-27)** *(On to a new line)* Thank you for holding, how can I help you?

MRS. VANDEVERE: Sam, it's Bunny Vandevere. Listen, I forgot to tell you, we're going to need table thirty-one tonight.

SAM: *(Looking for his dinner list)* Actually someone's reserved table thirty-one tonight.

MRS. VANDEVERE: *(Unfazed)* Well, we always sit there; we sort of have a standing reservation.

SAM: Well, actually we have a lot of customers who like to sit there and it's been reserved.

MRS. VANDEVERE: Well, who reserved it?

SAM: I can't tell you that, Mrs. Vandevere.

MRS. VANDEVER: Why not? I'm going to see who's sitting there anyway (A beat) Is it Carolan Rosenstein-Fishburn? *(Deeply peeved)* Oh for heaven's sake, Sam, it's not rocket science. Why don't you have Bob call me when he gets in? You don't seem to have the authority to handle it by yourself. *(She hangs up)* **(Pg 39-40)** *(Sam is stunned. Sits for a second in a mild state of shock, disliking the job intensely. – The phones are eerily quiet, so Sam makes a phone call)*

CURTIS: Diana Drake Agency.

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SAM: Curtis, have you guys been getting bad feedback about me?

CURTIS: Sam . . . I know this business with HBO was disappointing, but we've been over this. They decided to go in a different direction with the role. That's all.

SAM: Well, did they say why?

CURTIS: Sam, you're very talented, everyone knows you're talented .

SAM: But?

CURTIS: But you do tend to convey a certain lack of . . . entitlement. A sense of deserving, a sense of worthiness, a sense of status, if you will?

SAM: Have people actually said that, or is this from you?

CURTIS: *(Getting snippy)* Sam, you asked for feedback and I gave it to you. *(The phone rings)*

SAM: Okay, thanks *(New line)* Good afternoon, reservations; could you hold please?

R-F: This is Carolann Rosenstein-Fishburn calling for the third time today.

SAM: Okay Mrs. Fishburn, he can't come to the phone right now, but I'll have him *(Dial tone; she's hung up) (Sam buzzes upstairs)* Jean-Claude, can you watch the phones for like two minutes? I need to grab some food and I'm about to pee my pants.

JEAN-CLAUDE: Sam, what are you – five years old? I can't watch the phone for nobody! *(phone rings)*

SAM: **(Pg 43)** Reservations, could you hold please?

R-F: *(Livid)* No, it's Carolann Rosenstein-Fishburn. Put Jean-Claude on the phone this instant!! This is an emergency! You tell Jean-Claude that we are entertaining a major cultural dignitary this Friday and if we do not resolve this situation right away, we will transfer all our future business to Le Bernadin!

SAM: Okay, one moment please. **(Pg 48)** Reservations, could you hold please?

CURTIS: Surprise, surprise. Guess who go a callback at Lincoln Center tomorrow morning at ten-thirty?

SAM: *(Ecstatic)* Oh my God – Curtis! Do I need to prepare anything?

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CURTIS: Just a strong sense of personal entitlement. Toodle-oo *(He hangs up) (Phone rings) (Sam picks up, be before anything can be said)*

R-F: **(Pg 50-52)** It is Carolann Rosenstein-Fishburn calling for the tenth tie today. Put Jean-Claude on the phone this instant. I am not hanging up until you put him on the phone.

SAM: Well, he's still busy, but you are welcome to hold on for as long as you like. *(Sam buzzes upstairs)* Jean-Claude?

JEAN-CLAUDE: *(sucking up)* Listen, Sam, you need to do a really big favor for me, okay? We tooka special request for the Veccini table at five. *(Dripping with charm)* Well, I'm asking all the waiters, do they know the words to the song "Lady is the Tramp" and nobody seem to heard of it before.

SAM: No way.

JEAN-CLAUDE: Oh, Sam, come on, you supposed to be an actor. It's good experience, you never know, maybe the guy has connections in the movie business.

SAM: No, I'm . . .

JEAN-CLAUDE: Oh forget it! I mean if you were really and actor you wouldn't be answering phones all day now would you? *(He hangs up) (Stung Sam picks up a line, not sure who's there)*

SAM: Thank you for holding, how can I help you?

R-F: It is Carolann Rosen . . .

SAM: Oh, right. *(Suddenly taking charge)* You know what, Carolann . . . Jean-Claude has left for the day.

R-F: (You have got to be kidding.

SAM: *(Losing patience)* No I'm not. Why don't you just put your name on our waiting list for Friday and call it a day.

R-F: *(through clenched teeth)* All right, you little snot, put me in the first slot on the VIP priority Waiting list. Party of six. And why don't you put it under the name of our

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guest of honor – Bernard Gersten. Maybe you've heard of him. He's the executive producer of Lincoln Center.

SAM: *(a beat)* Actually, I have heard of him. *(testing the waters)* Yeah, it's so funny that you should mention his name because I'm actually up for a part in a show at Lincoln Center. In fact, I'm going for a callback tomorrow morning.

R-F: Well, Sam, that is funny because I just got off the phone with Bernie and I happen to know that there's nothing he love smore than the opportunity to help you're a struggling young actor.

SAM: Really?

R-F: Oh, yes.

SAM: *(Enjoying this)* You know what Carolann, I can't believe I overlooked this before. I just happened to notice that a table opened up on Friday night.

R-F: That's tremendous. And your last name Sam?

SAM: Peliczowski.

R-F: Marvelous. I'll call Bernie right now. And Sam, we'll need table thirty-one at eight-thirty.

SAM: Shouldn't be a problem. **(Pg 54)** *(Phone rings)* Reservations, how can I help you?

CURTIS: Sam, Curtis. You're not going to believe this. Diana just came back from a meeting at Lincoln Center and she was talking you up, so much so, that Bernard Gersten himself wants you to sop in and say hi after your audition. *(a beat) (Phone rings)* See, Sam, we're always working for you, even when you think we're not. *(Sam hangs up)*

SAM: *(with a new found confidence)* Reservations! *(mugs for the audience) (Lights out)*

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

2003 National Qualifier
2004 National Qualifier
2005 National Qualifier
2006 National Qualifier
2007 National Qualifier
2008 National Qualifier
2009 National Qualifier
2010 National Qualifier
2011 National Qualifier
2012 National Qualifier
2015 National Qualifier
2018 National Qualifier
CO State Qualifier
IL State Qualifier

Note from playwright: *Although Fully Committed was written with a male actor in mind, the role of SAM could easily be played by a woman. (pg 5)*

NOTES on CHARACTERS from the playwright:

1. *Mrs. Vandevere – A Park Avenue socialite and terminally dissatisfied.*
2. *Bryce – Extreme effeminate and aggressively friendly*
3. *Carolann Rosenstein-Fishburn: Iron-willed socialite with too much time on her hands.*
4. *Stephanie: British*
5. *Oscar: Lebanese (52-years old) Gentle, eccentric*
6. *Chef: Narcissist, vain and mildly thuggish. An overgrown frat boy. He talks in a cool, disaffected sexy way.*
7. *Jean-Claude – French – Wildly theatrical and drunk with his own power.*
8. *Curtis: Super witchy with a thick accent*

The humor in this cutting comes from pacing and well-developed characters.

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